

GUILLERMO BASTERRA

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EDUCATION

University of Southern California Los Angeles, CA  
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Disruptive Innovation Minor August 2022-May 2026  
• Activities: Center for AI in Society, Lambda Chi Alpha Men's Fraternity GPA: 3.6/4.0  
• Relevant coursework: Theory of Computation, Operating Systems, Probability Theory, Data Structures & Algorithms, NLP

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Prior Foundry (a16z Speedrun SR006 Batch) Los Angeles, CA  
Research Engineer, Part-time January 2025-Present  
• Built validation pipeline for company's LLM policy-simulation platform, running proposed legislation through survey-grounded agent populations to benchmark simulation accuracy against real social-science study outcomes  
• Designed confidence-scoring and profile-ablation harness used across agent runs — quantifies which persona attributes actually drive each simulated decision, surfacing where the model is responding to signal vs. noise  
• Shipped company's first CI/CD pipeline ahead of seed raise, taking deploys from manual SSH to push-to-main  
• Stack: Claude Code, FastAPI, Google Cloud Platform, PostgreSQL, Pytest, Playwright

Kantar, Digital Twins London, United Kingdom  
Applied AI Software Engineer June 2025-September 2025  
• Co-built a Digital Twins platform to simulate Fortune 500 consumer segments with LLM-driven personas, delivered to pilot clients alongside engineers from Microsoft and Kantar  
• Designed the "AI reasoning report" — a per-decision trace UI surfacing why each simulated consumer chose what it did, addressing #1 trust objection from enterprise buyers  
• Stack: FastAPI, Azure OneLake, LangChain, React, GPT models

Pencil AI, Insights and Predictions London, United Kingdom  
Applied AI Software Engineer June 2024-September 2024  
• Collaborated with Google Creative Works and gTech teams to develop a video advertisement evaluation platform  
• Cut LLM evaluation runtime by 85% (7m to 1m) while holding accuracy at 90% via a multi-agent consensus protocol and targeted prompt-engineering heuristics on Google Gemini  
• Stack: LangChain, Google Gemini API, FastAPI, Azure, React

USC Center for AI in Society Los Angeles, CA  
Research Assistant January 2023-May 2023  
• Engineered predictive models for wildfire occurrence and spread using geospatial and environmental datasets  
• Devised data pipeline and model architecture for wildfire project, using LSTMs and CNNs to account for sequential and 2D data  
• Stack: Scikit-learn, Pandas, GIS tools

ACADEMIC PROJECTS

Local-first Agentic Journal | GraphRAG, Ollama, ChromaDB Los Angeles  
Sole Engineer January 2026-December 2026  
• Built an on-device AI system to surface cognitive distortions in personal journals; fused a per-user knowledge graph with a hand-curated CBT corpus into a dual-retrieval prompt and enforced citation-or-drop validation, making hallucination structurally infeasible on a quantized 7B model  
• Shipped end-to-end: ingestion → graph extraction → retrieval orchestrator → SSE-streamed JSON detector → Tauri/React desktop client, all running with zero cloud dependency on consumer hardware

Google DeepMind Mentorship Los Angeles  
Mentee under Luis Piloto, DeepMind Research Scientist June 2022-September 2022  
• Selected for a 3 month machine learning mentorship under Luis Piloto (Google DeepMind)  
• Implemented core ML models and trained a simple CNN in TensorFlow for image classification tasks

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, C++, C, JavaScript/HTML/CSS, SQL, Flutter/Dart, Solidity (beginner)  
Frameworks/Libraries: React, Next.js, Node.js, FastAPI, PyTorch, Pandas, NumPy  
Developer Tools: Claude Code, Git, Docker, Neovim, PostgreSQL, SQL Server, Vercel, Linux